

Welcome & Course Overview

a4a Training Course — Module 1.0

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a4a stock assessment training — JRC, Ispra

Dates: 14–18/09/2026 *Online:*

https://teams.cloud.microsoft/1/team/19%3AY56b91x0VbSLUum4-KYSFNF_pcG8ZmbT

Your trainers

- **Danai Mantopoulou Palouka** — Scientific Officer, JRC
- **Alessandro Ligas** — Scientific Officer, JRC

Round table

 Let's go round the table — 10 minutes each

1. Who you are and where you work
2. **Which stock you brought** — species, area, how many years
3. What you currently use to assess it
4. What you want to walk out with on Friday

This course is built around your data

Two experts, two stocks, one week.

- Presentations are **deliberately short**
- Roughly **half the day is yours** to work on your own assessment
- We are around the whole time — interrupt us



What this means for you

By Friday the goal is not that you have seen a4a demonstrated — it is that **your own stock has been assessed, diagnosed and reported.**

The four pillars

Pillar	Topic	When
1	Data preparation & input	Day 1
2	Stock assessment workflow	Days 2–3
3	Advanced diagnostics & retrospective	Day 4
4	Reporting & presenting	Day 5

The week at a glance

Day	Focus	You will end the day with
1	FLR objects & data input	Your stock as an FLStock + FLIndex
2	First fit & residuals	A default fit you can read
3	Submodel refinement	A configuration you are happy with
4	Retrospective & simulation	Evidence your model is sound
5	Reference points & reporting	An assessment report

The daily rhythm

Time	Activity
09:00 – 10:30	Presentation + guided hands-on
10:30 – 10:45	Coffee
10:45 – 12:30	Your own data
12:30 – 14:00	Lunch
14:00 – 15:30	Presentation + guided hands-on
15:30 onwards	Your own data

Modular by design

Every module is **self-contained**. That means we can:

- **Skip** what you already know
- **Expand** what turns out to be hard
- **Reorder** if your data needs something sooner



Tell us

If a session is too basic, too fast, or not what you need — say so at the break.
The schedule is a proposal, not a contract.

Everything lives in the course folder, one folder per module:

```
course/  
  day01/  M1.0_welcome, M1.1_flr_intro, ...  
  day02/  ...
```

Each module folder contains:

- the **presentation** (.pdf, yours to keep)
- a **guided hands-on script** we run together
- an **exercise script** for your own data

Reference: <https://flrproject.org/FLa4a/>

Before we start — software check

 Run this now

Open `handson_M1.0_setup_check.R` and run it top to bottom.

It checks your R version, loads `FLCore`, `FLa4a` and `ggplotFL`, and runs a tiny assessment to prove the whole toolchain works.

If anything fails, flag it now — we fix it before Module 1.1.

Any questions?

Then let's start with Module 1.1 — **what FLR is and why a4a lives inside it.**